

PathBinder — Revenue Model

12-month projection at the 5% platform fee · gross + net margins · TCGplayer-comparable capture scenarios

CONTEXT

TCGplayer 2025 GMV: **\$1.612B** (ecDB / Grips Intelligence). TCGplayer's effective take rate is ~12–15% all-in; PathBinder charges 5% via Stripe Connect *application_fee_amount*. The gap is the seller's savings and PathBinder's acquisition pitch.

Two gross-profit scenarios are shown because the realised margin depends on how the Stripe Connect charge is configured. Scenario A is the eBay/Mercari model (seller absorbs Stripe via *on_behalf_of*); Scenario B is the default destination-charge behaviour where Stripe processing fees come out of the platform's funds. Worth confirming which one `/api/marketplace-checkout.js` actually uses before relying on Scenario A.

CAPTURE-RATE REVENUE TABLE

Annual revenue if PathBinder captures the indicated share of TCGplayer's 2025 GMV.

Scenario	Share of TCG	PathBinder GMV	Gross rev (A)	Gross rev (B)	# of txns/yr
Toehold	0.10%	\$1,612,000	\$80,600	\$22,338	38,381
Early traction	0.25%	\$4,030,000	\$201,500	\$55,844	95,952
Realistic Y1	0.50%	\$8,060,000	\$403,000	\$111,689	191,905
Strong Y2	1.00%	\$16,120,000	\$806,000	\$223,377	383,810
Aggressive	2.00%	\$32,240,000	\$1,612,000	\$446,754	767,619
Hypothetical max	5.00%	\$80,600,000	\$4,030,000	\$1,116,886	1,919,048

(A) 5% kept, Stripe fees billed to seller. **(B)** 5% kept minus Stripe 2.9% + \$0.30/txn paid by platform. Assumes average order value (AOV) of \$42.

MONTHLY INFRASTRUCTURE COSTS

Recurring SaaS + hosting at three scale tiers. Tier auto-selected by annual GMV in the trajectory below.

Line item	Low scale (<\$1M GMV/yr)	Mid scale (\$1–15M GMV/yr)	High scale (>\$15M GMV/yr)
Supabase (db + storage + auth)	\$25	\$200	\$600
Vercel (hosting + edge functions)	\$20	\$100	\$400
Domain + SSL	\$1	\$1	\$1
Email service (Resend / Postmark)	\$20	\$50	\$200

Error monitoring (Sentry)	\$0	\$50	\$200
Customer support tooling	\$0	\$50	\$200
Image storage / bandwidth overage	\$0	\$50	\$300
Misc dev SaaS (analytics, CI, etc.)	\$50	\$200	\$500
Total / month	\$116	\$701	\$2,401
Total / year	\$1,392	\$8,412	\$28,812

Excludes payroll / contractor cost (assumes Chals as sole operator), marketing spend (variable, deferred), warehouse / fulfillment infra (only if PathBinder Direct equivalent gets built — Year 2+ decision).

12-month trajectory — three scenarios

Monthly GMV / revenue / costs / net profit for each scenario.

PESSIMISTIC

Month	GMV	Gross rev (A)	Gross rev (B)	Infra	Chargebacks	Net (A)	Net (B)
M1	\$10,000	\$500	\$139	\$701	\$7	\$-208	\$-570
M2	\$18,000	\$900	\$249	\$701	\$13	\$186	\$-464
M3	\$30,000	\$1,500	\$416	\$701	\$21	\$778	\$-307
M4	\$50,000	\$2,500	\$693	\$701	\$36	\$1,763	\$-44
M5	\$80,000	\$4,000	\$1,109	\$701	\$57	\$3,242	\$350
M6	\$110,000	\$5,500	\$1,524	\$701	\$79	\$4,720	\$745
M7	\$140,000	\$7,000	\$1,940	\$701	\$100	\$6,199	\$1,139
M8	\$170,000	\$8,500	\$2,356	\$701	\$121	\$7,678	\$1,533
M9	\$195,000	\$9,750	\$2,702	\$701	\$139	\$8,910	\$1,862
M10	\$215,000	\$10,750	\$2,979	\$701	\$154	\$9,895	\$2,125
M11	\$235,000	\$11,750	\$3,256	\$701	\$168	\$10,881	\$2,388
M12	\$250,000	\$12,500	\$3,464	\$701	\$179	\$11,620	\$2,585
YEA R	\$1,503,000	\$75,150	\$20,827	\$8,412	\$1,074	\$65,664	\$11,342

Y1 GMV \$1,503,000 · Net margin (A) 4.37% · Net margin (B) 0.75% · Infra tier: mid

REALISTIC

Month	GMV	Gross rev (A)	Gross rev (B)	Infra	Chargebacks	Net (A)	Net (B)
M1	\$25,000	\$1,250	\$346	\$701	\$18	\$531	\$-372
M2	\$60,000	\$3,000	\$831	\$701	\$43	\$2,256	\$88
M3	\$110,000	\$5,500	\$1,524	\$701	\$79	\$4,720	\$745
M4	\$200,000	\$10,000	\$2,771	\$701	\$143	\$9,156	\$1,928
M5	\$350,000	\$17,500	\$4,850	\$701	\$250	\$16,549	\$3,899
M6	\$525,000	\$26,250	\$7,275	\$701	\$375	\$25,174	\$6,199
M7	\$700,000	\$35,000	\$9,700	\$701	\$500	\$33,799	\$8,499
M8	\$900,000	\$45,000	\$12,471	\$701	\$643	\$43,656	\$11,128
M9	\$1,100,000	\$55,000	\$15,243	\$701	\$786	\$53,513	\$13,756
M10	\$1,300,000	\$65,000	\$18,014	\$701	\$929	\$63,370	\$16,385

M11	\$1,400,000	\$70,000	\$19,400	\$701	\$1,000	\$68,299	\$17,699
M12	\$1,500,000	\$75,000	\$20,786	\$701	\$1,071	\$73,228	\$19,013
YEA R	\$8,170,000	\$408,500	\$113,213	\$8,412	\$5,836	\$394,252	\$98,965

Y1 GMV \$8,170,000 · Net margin (A) 4.83% · Net margin (B) 1.21% · Infra tier: mid

OPTIMISTIC

Month	GMV	Gross rev (A)	Gross rev (B)	Infra	Chargebacks	Net (A)	Net (B)
M1	\$40,000	\$2,000	\$554	\$2,401	\$29	\$-430	\$-1,875
M2	\$120,000	\$6,000	\$1,663	\$2,401	\$86	\$3,513	\$-824
M3	\$250,000	\$12,500	\$3,464	\$2,401	\$179	\$9,920	\$885
M4	\$500,000	\$25,000	\$6,929	\$2,401	\$357	\$22,242	\$4,170
M5	\$900,000	\$45,000	\$12,471	\$2,401	\$643	\$41,956	\$9,428
M6	\$1,400,000	\$70,000	\$19,400	\$2,401	\$1,000	\$66,599	\$15,999
M7	\$1,800,000	\$90,000	\$24,943	\$2,401	\$1,286	\$86,313	\$21,256
M8	\$2,200,000	\$110,000	\$30,486	\$2,401	\$1,571	\$106,028	\$26,513
M9	\$2,500,000	\$125,000	\$34,643	\$2,401	\$1,786	\$120,813	\$30,456
M10	\$2,750,000	\$137,500	\$38,107	\$2,401	\$1,964	\$133,135	\$33,742
M11	\$2,900,000	\$145,000	\$40,186	\$2,401	\$2,071	\$140,528	\$35,713
M12	\$3,000,000	\$150,000	\$41,571	\$2,401	\$2,143	\$145,456	\$37,028
YEA R	\$18,360,000	\$918,000	\$254,417	\$28,812	\$13,114	\$876,074	\$212,491

Y1 GMV \$18,360,000 · Net margin (A) 4.77% · Net margin (B) 1.16% · Infra tier: high

Sensitivity: what if you raised the fee?

Realistic-scenario Y1 GMV (\$8.17M) under different platform fee rates.

Fee rate	Gross rev (A)	Gross rev (B)	Net rev (A)	Net rev (B)	Net margin (B)	Competitor
5%	\$408,500	\$113,213	\$394,252	\$98,965	1.21%	PathBinder today
7%	\$571,900	\$276,613	\$557,652	\$262,365	3.21%	—
8%	\$653,600	\$358,313	\$639,352	\$344,065	4.21%	Cardmarket-ish
10%	\$817,000	\$521,713	\$802,752	\$507,465	6.21%	—
12%	\$980,400	\$685,113	\$966,152	\$670,865	8.21%	Whatnot / eBay
15%	\$1,225,500	\$930,213	\$1,211,252	\$915,965	11.21%	TCGplayer

Net margin column uses Scenario B (platform absorbs Stripe) — the conservative read. Each 1% added to the fee at realistic Y1 GMV is roughly +\$81,700 of gross revenue.

MODEL ASSUMPTIONS

- **TCGplayer 2025 GMV:** \$1,612,000,000 (ecDB / Grips Intelligence).
- **PathBinder fee:** 5% application_fee_amount on each marketplace charge.
- **Stripe fees:** 2.9% + \$0.30/txn (Stripe's published standard rate).
- **Average order value (AOV):** \$42 — blended estimate for TCG singles + sealed.
- **Chargeback rate:** 0.2% of orders × \$15 per dispute (Stripe's dispute fee, charged regardless of outcome).
- **Infrastructure tiers:** auto-selected by annual GMV; figures based on real Supabase/Vercel/Resend/Sentry pricing.
- **Excluded from net:** payroll/contractors (assumes you're sole operator), customer acquisition spend (variable), fulfillment infrastructure (deferred Y2+ decision), legal/accounting (~\$1–3K/yr).
- **Excluded from GMV:** any growth assumption beyond pure capture of current TCGplayer baseline — TCGplayer was up 120% YoY in 2025, so any reasonable share of a growing pie likely overstates here.
- **Trajectory shape:** three hand-crafted monthly ramps. Pessimistic plateaus at \$250K/mo; Realistic ramps to \$1.5M/mo by M12; Optimistic exits at \$3M/mo.